

UNIT 1

Lights, camera, action!

A film is—or should be—more like music than like fiction. It should be a progression of moods and feelings.

—Stanley Kubrick

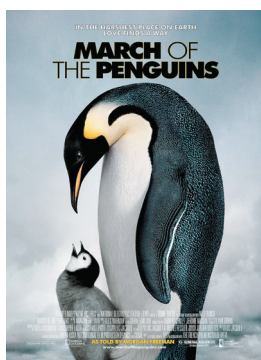


In this unit, you are going to:

- read a lecture transcript about some aspects of film-making behind the scenes;
- write a film review;
- read an excerpt from the script of a classic film;
- dub a film scene.

Welcome to the unit

The film poster is often used to advertise a film. Look at the film posters below and discuss the following questions in pairs.



Below is a list of some popular film types:

- | | |
|---------------|-------------------|
| • Action | • Horror |
| • Cartoon | • Musical |
| • Comedy | • Romance |
| • Documentary | • Science fiction |
| • Fantasy | • War |

- 1 What type of film is shown on each poster?
- 2 Which film type do you like best? Why?

Reading



Many different elements go into making a film. The lecture below was given by a film critic at the school Film Festival. Before you read the lecture transcript, think about the following questions:

- What elements of a film can you think of?
- Which element do you think is the most important in making a successful film?

Behind the scenes



Hello, everyone! Let me start by asking you a question: what's the first thing you notice about a film? The acting? The music? Maybe the amazing sets? Whatever your answer is, there's always a lot more to it than first meets the eye. Actually, the film you see on the screen is the product of a huge amount of hard work, most of which takes place behind the scenes. Today, I'll give you a brief introduction to some aspects of film-making you might not be familiar with.

To begin with, I'd like to draw your attention to an important factor of a film—sound effects. These are often added after a scene has been shot and might not be made in the way you would expect. For example, in *Jurassic Park*, the sounds of different animals, including a baby elephant and a tiger, were mixed by a computer to make a dinosaur roar. The sound of the doors opening in the *Star Trek* films was made simply by pulling a sheet of paper out of an envelope.



Another aspect I attach great importance to is visual special effects. CGI has been frequently used in film-making as a special effects technology. Generally, scenes requiring CGI are filmed in front of a green screen in the studio. As green doesn't

20 background. This enables CGI effects to be added later. The Quidditch scenes in the Harry Potter films were made in this way with the actors jumping up and down in front of a green screen. However, the aid of computers isn't always preferred. Peter Jackson, director of *The Lord of the Rings* films, took a creative approach—he used clever camera angles to make characters seem bigger or smaller than they really were.

25 Props also contribute to a film's success. To make a film look real, great effort must sometimes be made to research, find and build objects. Director James Cameron spent six months looking at and revising plans of the *Titanic* in order to build a full-sized model for his 1997 film. He talked to historians to ensure that the details were correct and even went down to the bottom of the Atlantic Ocean to see what
30 was left of the ship for himself. It took 500 workers 100 days to build the fine model, not to mention the thousands of props inside.

My lecture today may not be able to do justice to all the work people have done behind the scenes. Just as the poor passengers on the real *Titanic* saw the tip of the iceberg, what we see on the cinema screen is just the tip of the huge iceberg of film-
35 making. Hopefully, next time you go to the cinema, you'll spare a thought for all those talented people behind the scenes. They have worked for months and even years so that you can have two hours of enjoyment!



Grammar and usage

Subject-verb agreement

A Exploring the rules

Below is an introduction Laura gave to her class about *The Jungle Book*. Pay attention to the underlined subjects and verbs and fill in the table below. The first two have been done for you.

Everyone was surprised when Disney said its film team members were remaking *The Jungle Book*. Based on Rudyard Kipling's book of the same title, it describes the story of a boy named Mowgli. Mowgli and his animal friends live happily in the jungle until one day Shere Khan the tiger returns and tries to drive him out of the jungle. In 1967, Disney adapted the book into a cartoon film, which is widely regarded as a classic. However, its old age shows. The new film uses much more advanced technology—not only the animals but also the jungle is digitally created. Building the jungle environment on the computer was no easy job. It took more than 800 artists over a year to work on the project. *The Jungle Book* lasts for about two hours but there is enough tension and humour to hold your attention during the whole film. Two hours seems very short when you're having so much fun!

Subject + Singular verb	Subject + Plural verb
Everyone was	its film team members were

Working out the rules

- Subject-verb agreement means choosing the correct singular or plural verb according to the (1) _____.
- The verb should be singular if the subject is (2) _____; the verb should be plural if the subject is (3) _____.

**You can choose more than one answer for each blank.*

- | | |
|---------------------------|--|
| a a singular noun | f a phrase of two or more words linked by <i>and</i> , |
| b a plural noun | referring to two or more objects or people |
| c an uncountable noun | g a pronoun like <i>everyone</i> |
| d a book/film title | h a phrase of measurement like <i>two hours</i> |
| e a verb- <i>ing</i> form | |
- When *not only ... but also ...* is used as the subject of a sentence, or *there be* is followed by two or more nouns as the subject of a sentence, the verb agrees with the noun closest to it.

👉 Grammar notes → pages 97–98

A Understanding the text

A1 Read the lecture transcript and complete the chart below with the main idea of each paragraph.

Introduction (Para. 1): Some aspects of film-making behind the scenes require a lot of hard work.	
Main body:	Aspect 1 (Para. 2): (1) _____ _____
	Aspect 2 (Para. 3): (2) _____ _____
	Aspect 3 (Para. 4): (3) _____ _____
Conclusion (Para. 5): (4) _____	

A2 Read the lecture transcript again carefully and complete the table below.

Main points	Examples
Many sound effects might not be made in the way you would expect.	(1) _____ _____
(2) _____ _____	The Quidditch scenes in the Harry Potter films were made with the actors jumping in front of a green screen.
The aid of computers isn't always preferred.	(3) _____ _____
Props contribute to a film's success.	(4) _____ _____

A3 In pairs, discuss the following questions.

- 1 Why do you think the film critic asks a question at the beginning of his lecture?
- 2 What conclusion can you draw from the lecture?
- 3 Do you support the use of CGI in films? Why or why not?

B Building your language

B1 Simon is talking about his favourite film at the school Film Festival. Complete what he says with the correct forms of the words and phrase in the box below.

prefer	factor	aid	actually
enable	approach	frequently	be familiar with

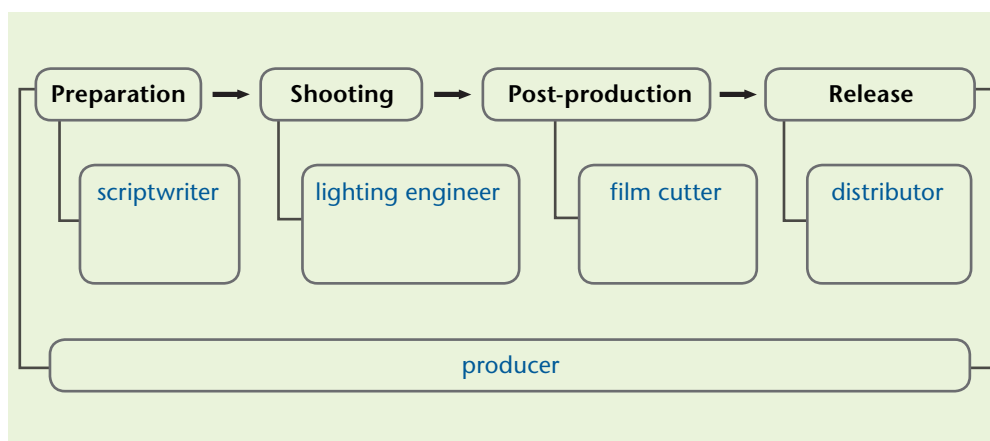
To the (1) _____ asked question, "What's your favourite film?", my answer is *Crouching Tiger, Hidden Dragon*. It has won many awards, including an Academy Award for Best Foreign Language Film. It has also (2) _____ Western audiences to have a better understanding of Chinese culture.

You must (3) _____ the exciting fighting scene on top of a bamboo forest in *Crouching Tiger, Hidden Dragon*. With the (4) _____ of the computer, scenes like this could have been made in the studio. However, the film's director, Ang Lee, (5) _____ to have actors perform on location. He believed this (6) _____ to film-making would create a "human connection" which could not be achieved with CGI special effects.

In addition to the amazing martial arts, the film also took advantage of China's beautiful mountains, forests and deserts. (7) _____, it was shot in different locations all around the country. All these (8) _____ contributed to the film's success.

B2 There are a lot of people working in the film industry. Fill in the flow chart below with different film-related jobs from the box. Then add more film-related jobs to the flow chart.

actor	cameraman	costume designer	director
film critic	make-up artist	production designer	set designer
sound engineer	special effects engineer	stuntman	voice actor



Tip

Learning topic-related words

Learning vocabulary by topic helps you see the connection between words and phrases. This enables you to remember them more effectively. You can create different lists of words according to different topics.

B3 The film critic uses a metaphor in his lecture to describe the fact that a lot of work is done behind the scenes in film-making. Find the metaphor in the lecture and write a metaphor of your own to describe the film-making process.

Learn this A metaphor compares one thing to another without using "as" or "like". It draws the reader's attention to the similarities between two things. This way, unfamiliar things can be explained with something people are more familiar with.

B Applying the rules

B1 Circle the correct words to complete the following sentences.

- 1 Is/Are five million dollars enough to make a good film?
- 2 I think Mowgli and Shere Khan **is/are** the most interesting characters in *The Jungle Book*.
- 3 Drinking cola often **makes/make** the cinema experience more enjoyable.
- 4 There **is/are** one tree and three children on the film poster.
- 5 *Fantastic Beasts and Where to Find Them* **was/were** directed by David Yates.
- 6 If anyone **is/are** interested in the film, please let me know.

B2 After the talk, Laura chatted with Simon. Complete the conversation with the correct forms of the verbs in the box below. Some verbs can be used more than once.

be	look	make	require
----	------	------	---------

Simon: *The Jungle Book* sounds great. But what (1) _____ the new film so much better than the original?

Laura: The picture quality, as well as the special effects, (2) _____ far better. Not only the animals but also the forest (3) _____ so real! While you watch, you feel like reaching out your hand to touch the leaves.

Simon: Sounds super! Believe it or not, there (4) _____ only one real human character in the film.

Laura: That's Mowgli, played by a child actor named Neel Sethi. The rest (5) _____ all digitally created.

Simon: Does that mean he had to act alone?

Laura: Yes. When he acted alone in front of a green screen, a lot of imagination (6) _____. There was another problem: the digitally created animals had no shadows, but the film team (7) _____ able to find a solution.

Simon: How was the problem solved?

Laura: Light and shadows (8) _____ thrown onto Mowgli with the aid of a system they developed, showing that animals were moving near him.

Simon: That's really interesting and creative!

B3 Write a short paragraph about 3-D films. Use the following information to help you. Pay attention to subject-verb agreement.

3-D films	
History	Were first made in 1915
Advantage	Make things look like they are coming out of the screen
Disadvantages	• Sometimes cause headaches and sickness for viewers • Need a special cinema and 3-D glasses
Examples	<i>Avatar</i> , <i>Life of Pi</i> , <i>Titanic</i> (changed to a 3-D film after filming)

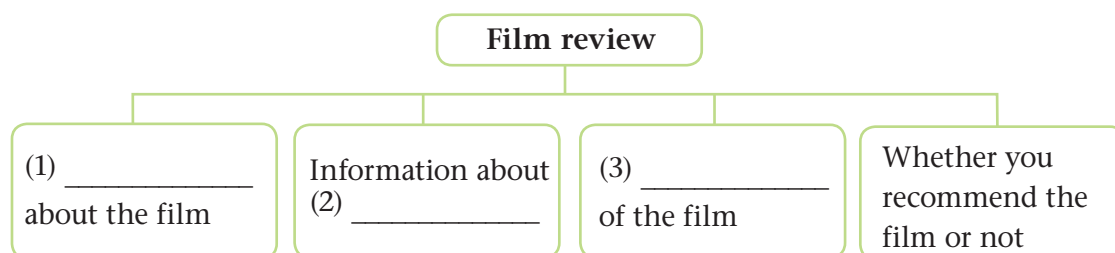
Integrated skills

Reviewing a film

A At the school Film Festival, Miss Li, the organizer, is talking about how to write a film review. Listen and finish the exercises below.



A1 Listen to Miss Li's introduction and complete the chart below.



A2 Listen to Miss Li's introduction again and complete the notes below.

Writing a film review

Dos

- Give the name of the film, the director's name and the names of (1) _____.
- Give information about when and where the film is set and what happens in the film.
- Include details about the acting, characters, music or (2) _____.
- Use lots of interesting adjectives.
- Describe (3) _____ that you think might enjoy the film.

Don'ts

- Don't say what happens (4) _____ of the film.
- Don't make the reader (5) _____ what you think.
- Don't give your opinion without (6) _____.

B Read the film review of *The King's Speech* below and try to understand its structure.



The King's Speech

The King's Speech is a 2010 British film directed by Tom Hooper. The film stars Colin Firth as King George VI, Geoffrey Rush as Lionel Logue and Helena Bonham Carter as Queen Elizabeth. At the 83rd Academy Awards (the Oscars), the film won Best Picture and Colin Firth won Best Actor in a Leading Role.

Based on a true story, the film is set in London in the 1930s. Prince Albert, second son of King George V, suffers from a terrible speech problem. The Prince has given up hope of a cure but his wife, Elizabeth, takes him to see Lionel Logue, an Australian speech doctor living in London. Although the two men have very different backgrounds and do not get along at first, they eventually become friends. After the Prince's elder brother gives up being King, Prince Albert becomes King George VI.

The film looks like a fairly typical historical film without fancy special effects, and it is made enjoyable by the performances of the main actors. Firth is successful in showing us the King's struggles as well as his courage. He has great chemistry with Rush and Bonham Carter, whose characters are both very believable. In the meantime, Hooper skilfully creates uncertainty and tension with narrow indoor sets and dark lighting.

All in all, I highly recommend this film. If you enjoy true stories or films about history, you will love *The King's Speech*.

C In pairs, discuss the film you are going to review. Use the following questions and expressions to help you.

- What type of film is it?
- Who are the director and the main actors?
- When and where is the film set?
- What is the storyline of the film?
- What is your opinion of the film? (Consider the storyline, acting, characters, music and special effects.)
- Who do you think would like the film?

Expressions

Talking about feelings

I felt inspired/excited/frightened after watching ...

I was really confused about the plot of ...

I was absolutely fed up with the special effects of ...

I couldn't stand ...

I was especially pleased with ...

I wasn't happy about ...

... appealed to me/didn't appeal to me because ...

D Write a film review. Use your ideas from part C and the information in parts A and B to help you.

Planning your writing

• Learning about the text type

A film review is a report that expresses an opinion about a film. The purpose of a film review is to give information to the potential audience so that they can decide whether or not they want to watch the film.

• Learning about the structure

When writing a film review, you can follow the structure below:

- Start by giving basic information about the film.
- Provide information about the storyline.
- Give your opinion of the film.
- State clearly whether you recommend the film or not.

• Learning about the language

Use adjectives, either positive or negative, to make your description more vivid and interesting, e.g. *amazing/terrible, exciting/boring, original/unoriginal*.

Checking your writing

Remember to check your writing after you finish and exchange drafts between you and your partner. Pay attention to the following aspects:

☐ Punctuation

☐ Spelling

☐ Grammar

☐ Choice of words

☐ Style (formal/informal)

☐ Structure

Self-review

- Does your film review contain all the necessary parts? Is your opinion of the film supported by enough evidence?
- How can you improve your writing?

Peer review

- What does your partner think of the information and the opinion you give?
- How can you improve your writing?

Extended reading



Read the introduction to the film *Forrest Gump* and the excerpt from its script.

Forrest Gump

(Excerpt)

Forrest Gump is a 1994 film starring Tom Hanks. It tells the story of Forrest Gump, a simple man with a warm personality. Despite an IQ of 75, he lives a truly amazing life. He sees, and sometimes influences, some of the major events of the United States in the second half of the 20th century.

5 *Mrs Gump and Forrest wait for the school bus. The bus pulls up as Mrs Gump prepares Forrest for his first day of school.*

MRS GUMP: You do your very best now, Forrest.

FORREST: I sure will, Momma.

10 **FORREST (Voice-over^①):** I remember the bus ride on the first day of school very well.

The bus driver opens the door and looks down. Forrest walks to the steps of the bus and looks at the bus driver.

BUS DRIVER: Are you coming along?

FORREST: Momma said not to be taking rides from strangers.

15 **BUS DRIVER:** This is the bus to school.

FORREST: I'm Forrest. Forrest Gump.

BUS DRIVER: I'm Dorothy Harris.

FORREST: Well, now we aren't strangers anymore.

The bus driver smiles as Forrest steps up into the bus.

20 *Mrs Gump waves to Forrest as the bus drives away. Forrest begins to walk down the bus.*

Two young boys look up from the seat.

BOY 1: This seat's taken.

BOY 2: It's taken!

25 *Forrest looks around. A larger girl moves over so Forrest can't sit next to her. She shakes her head. Forrest looks to the other side where a boy sits alone on a larger seat. The boy looks angrily at Forrest.*



① Voice-over: Voice-over refers to the lines in a film that are spoken by a person not seen on the screen. In this scene the grown-up Forrest is remembering a story from his childhood.

- BOY 3:** You can't sit here.
- 30 **FORREST (Voice-over):** You know, it's funny what a young man recollects. Because I don't remember being born. I, I ... don't recall what I got for my first Christmas and I don't know when I went on my first outdoor picnic. But, I do remember the first time I heard the sweetest voice in the wide world.
- 35 **GIRL:** You can sit here if you want.
Forrest looks back at Jenny Curran, a young girl about Forrest's age.
- FORREST (Voice-over):** I had never seen anything so beautiful in my life. She was like an angel.
- JENNY:** Well, are you going to sit down, or aren't you?
- 40 *Forrest sits down next to Jenny.*
- JENNY:** What's wrong with your legs?
- FORREST:** Um, nothing at all, thank you. My legs are just fine and dandy.
- FORREST (Voice-over):** I just sat next to her on that bus and had a conversation all the way to school.
- 45 **JENNY:** Then why do you have those shoes on?
- FORREST:** My momma said my back's crooked like a question mark. These are going to make me as straight as an arrow. They're my magic shoes.
- 50 **FORREST (Voice-over):** And next to Momma, no one ever talked to me or asked me questions.
- JENNY:** Are you stupid or something?
- FORREST:** Momma says stupid is as stupid does.
Jenny puts her hand out toward Forrest. Forrest reaches over and shakes her hand.
- 55 **JENNY:** I'm Jenny.
- FORREST:** I'm Forrest. Forrest Gump.
- FORREST (Voice-over):** From that day on, we was always together. Jenny and me was like peas and carrots.

A In pairs, find information about each of the following aspects of the film excerpt and complete the table.

Setting	
Characters (relationships between them, their personalities, etc.)	
Plot	

B What are your favourite lines from films? Explain why you like them.

Project

Dubbing a film scene

A As a class, discuss some film scenes that you like. Use the ideas below to help you. Then in groups, choose a film scene you are going to dub.

Are there enough characters in the scene for everyone in your group?

It does not matter if there are more characters than group members: one person can play more than one character.

Are the words clear to understand?

Try not to choose a scene where characters are talking too quickly or using language that is too difficult.



Do the characters speak more or less the same amount?

Try not to choose a scene where one person will have to do most of the speaking.

How long does the scene last?

A scene that lasts two or three minutes is preferred.

B As a group, practise dubbing the chosen film scene together.

Tip

Voice acting

- Speak clearly and try to stay in time with the character speaking in the film.
- Use your body language to get into character and help the feelings come naturally. Even though only your voice will be heard, you need to act with your whole body.

C As a group, present your dubbing to the rest of the class.

You can present your dubbing in different ways:

- Record both your dubbing and the film scene, and present the video in class.
- Record your dubbing and present the audio in class.
- Perform your dubbing in class, without recording in advance.

UNIT 2

Be sporty, be healthy

A sound mind starts from a sound body. How can a weak body develop a sound mind?

—Cai Yuanpei



In this unit, you are going to:

- read a beginner's guide to exercise;
- write an email to encourage your friend to work out regularly;
- read a magazine article about a Chinese high school student's tai chi experience;
- do a survey on students' exercise habits.

Welcome to the unit

Sport is fun in different ways. Read the jokes below about different sports and discuss the following questions in pairs.

Q: What do soccer players and magicians have in common?

A: Both do hat-tricks!

Q: What is the hardest part about skydiving?

A: The ground!

Q: What animal is best at hitting baseballs?

A: A bat!

Q: Why can't Cinderella play soccer?

A: Because she's always running away from the ball.

Q: How do basketball players stay cool during the game?

A: They stand close to the fans.

- 1 What do you think is funny about these jokes?
- 2 What is your favourite sport? Why do you like it?

Reading



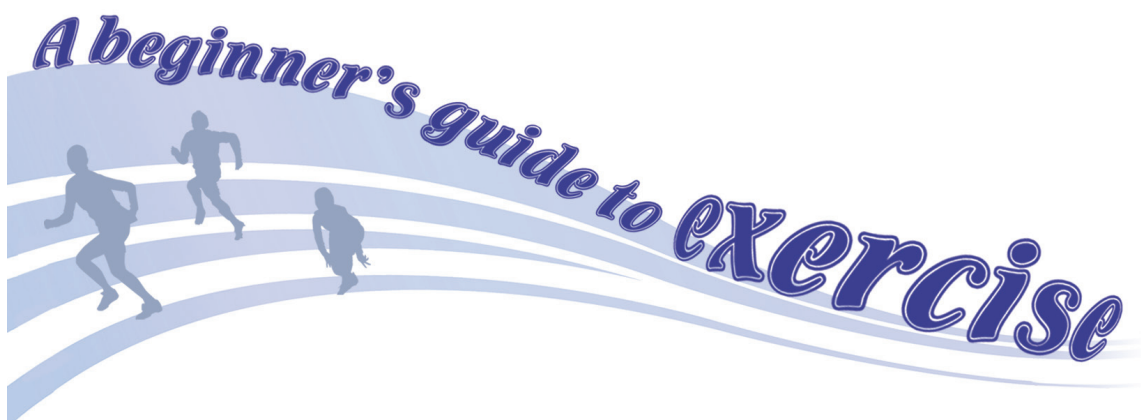
Many people are interested in getting into shape but are uncertain about how to start. The guide below gives information on exercise for beginners. Before you read the guide, think about the following questions:

- What might prevent people from starting exercise?
- What kind of information do you think this guide will give?

Tip

Predicting the main idea of a text

Before reading a text, take a brief look at the title, subheadings or pictures in it. Then try to guess what important information the text is going to give. By making predictions, you connect the text you are going to read with your background knowledge and become a more active reader.



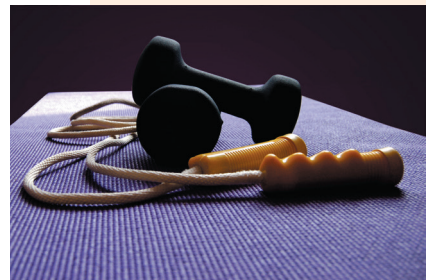
You want to start doing exercise? Congratulations! You have just taken your first step towards a new and improved you!

Understanding the benefits of exercise

- Most people assume that regular exercise does wonders for the body and mind—
- 5 but what exactly are its health benefits? To start with, physical activity increases the efficiency of your heart and lungs. During exercise, your heart and lungs must work harder. This extra effort makes them grow stronger over the long term. It has also been proven that active people tend to have better immune systems and are at lower risk of diseases. Moreover, exercise is good for your mental health. Working
- 10 out can help you reduce stress and get over negative feelings. Some studies even show that exercise improves certain brain functions, meaning you could actually exercise your way to better performance at school!

Planning your exercise routine

When you plan an exercise routine, the first thing to consider is what you expect to improve: heart and lung efficiency, muscle strength or flexibility. Aerobic activities, like jogging, swimming and skiing, develop your heart and lungs. Strength training, such as pull-ups and weightlifting, increases muscle strength and encourages bone development. Flexibility training, including gymnastics and tai chi, helps stretch your muscles and improve your body's range of movement. These types of exercise all play a role in a healthy routine. Above all, choose activities you enjoy because, in this way, you're more likely to stick with them.



Eating and drinking right

Like cars that run on petrol, your body burns carbohydrates for energy. Foods like noodles, rice, fruit and vegetables give your body plenty of carbohydrates to keep up your energy during a long workout. To help your muscles recover and repair themselves after exercise, you need to eat foods rich in protein, such as fish, eggs and milk products. When to eat is also of great importance. In general, you should have your meal an average of 1.5 to 2.5 hours before exercising. Do not eat immediately after exercise; instead, wait at least 30 minutes after a typical routine, or as much as an hour after a hard workout. Remember to drink throughout exercise to make up for water lost to sweat.



Avoiding injury

To prevent soft tissue injury, make sure that you wear proper clothes and equipment when exercising. You should also start small and slowly work your way to a longer and harder exercise routine to avoid getting hurt. Finally, remember to warm up before exercising and stretch at the end of your workout.



So, now you know the benefits of exercise and how to do it safely and effectively. What are you waiting for?

A Understanding the text

A1 The guide can be divided into four parts. Read the guide and complete the chart below with the main idea of each part.

Understanding the benefits of exercise • Physical benefits • (1) _____	Eating and drinking right • What to eat • (3) _____ • Drinking water
Planning your exercise routine • (2) _____ • What types of exercise you enjoy	Avoiding injury • (4) _____ • Starting small • (5) _____

A2 Read the guide again carefully and answer the following questions.

1 Why is regular exercise good for the heart and lungs?

2 How does flexibility training help you?

3 Why do you need to eat foods rich in protein?

4 How long should you wait after exercise to have your meal?

A3 In pairs, discuss the following questions.

1 What are the purposes of this guide? What techniques does the guide use for these purposes? Support your answer with examples from the guide.

2 Do you agree with the guide that exercise can help you get over negative feelings? Back up your opinion with examples from your experience.

3 What other information do you think could be included in the guide?

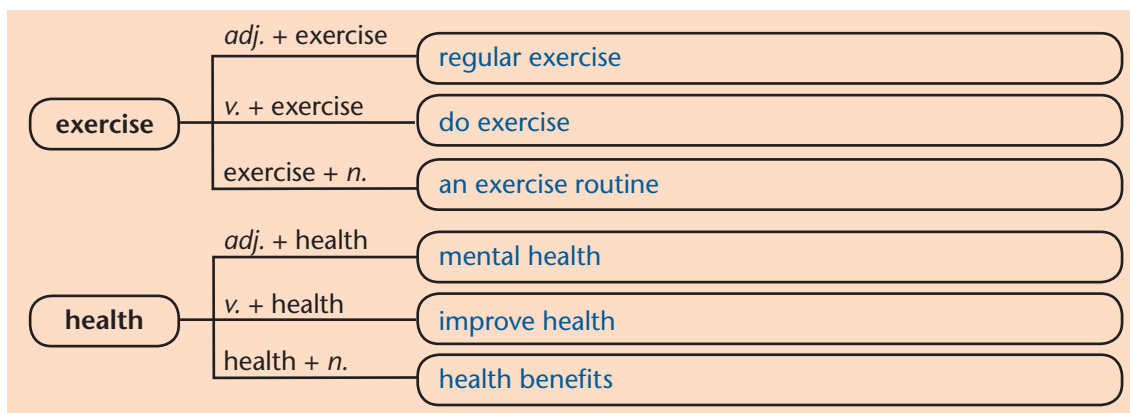
B Building your language

B1 The passage below deals with a common false idea about exercise. Complete the passage with the correct forms of the words and phrases in the box below.

moreover	assume	average	over the long term
jogging	prevent	tend to	make up for

Exercise has a range of health benefits. However, some people (1) _____ that if some exercise is good, more is always better, so they (2) _____ exercise for a long time without stopping. For example, some people go (3) _____ for several hours at a time because of the step-counting smartphone apps. Others work out for hours at the weekend (4) _____ their lack of exercise during the weekdays. Habits like these put stress on the body, and if they are maintained (5) _____, can become a serious health risk. Generally speaking, aerobic routines that last over 100 minutes have a certain health risk. On the other hand, they should not be shorter than 10 minutes. If you do exercise for only a few minutes, you may not be working out long enough to see any benefits from it. When you exercise, aim for the daily (6) _____ of 30 to 60 minutes. This will (7) _____ you from getting hurt. (8) _____, it will ensure that the exercise you do has a positive effect on your physical health.

B2 "Exercise" and "health" appear in the guide as part of different collocations. Read the examples below and add more collocations.



B3 The guide uses cautious language to describe something that may not be true in every case. Find the sentences using cautious language in the guide and revise the sentences below using cautious language.

Learn this Cautious language is used to avoid overgeneralizing. Pay attention to the following words and phrases:

Modal verbs: can, could, may, might, should, would

Verbs and verb phrases: appear, look like, seem, tend to

Adverbs and adverbial phrases: probably, usually, sometimes, mainly, in general

Adjectives: likely, possible, probable, unlikely

People do not like getting up early for morning exercise in cold weather. They want to get as much sleep as they can. However, truly healthy people get their workout done anyway. They know they will feel great afterwards.

Grammar and usage

Passive voice in the present continuous and present perfect tenses

A Exploring the rules

Frances is reading a leaflet about a sports centre. Find the sentences in the leaflet that use the passive voice in the present continuous and present perfect tenses and fill in the table below. The first two have been done for you.

Are you ready to get fit? We are happy to announce that the Community Sports Centre will soon be open to the public once again! Our facilities have been enlarged and redone, and our centre is now bigger and better than ever before. The finishing touches are now being put to a new swimming pool and our workout rooms have been updated with modern equipment. Come by and check them out!

There are a lot of fitness courses for you to choose from. In response to public interest, our aerobics class has been replaced with several fun options, including modern dance. You can find more details about all our courses on our website. Better still, we will update our fitness courses every few months so that more popular courses can be included. Weight training classes, for example, are being designed and will be added to our programme soon. We will invite professional athletes to be our coaches. We are confident that we have something for everyone. We look forward to seeing you here!

Passive voice in the present continuous tense	The finishing touches are now being put to a new swimming pool ...
Passive voice in the present perfect tense	Our facilities have been enlarged and redone ...

Working out the rules

- We use the passive voice in the present continuous tense to talk about something that is being done right now. The verb form is “(1) _____”.
- We use the passive voice in the present perfect tense to talk about something that has been done. The verb form is “(2) _____”.

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B Applying the rules

B1 Rewrite the following sentences using the passive voice.

1 The city government is building a new community sports centre.

2 Some workers are painting the walls in the workout rooms.

3 People have told me the new workout rooms are very modern.

4 Jenny's PE teacher has asked her to make an exercise plan.

5 The teachers are testing students on their knowledge of fitness.

B2 Frances has written a review of the sports centre. Complete the review with the correct forms of the verbs in the brackets.

I visited the new and improved Community Sports Centre. It looks amazing! It is not open to the public yet, but preparations ⁽¹⁾ _____ (make) presently for the reopening.

Lots of new and modern facilities ⁽²⁾ _____ (put) in place. Some of the exercise machines ⁽³⁾ _____ (test) by a group of energetic young people now. A whole new range of courses ⁽⁴⁾ _____ (design) for people of all ages, including tai chi and boxing! I tried out the boxing class and I loved it! The coach, who was a boxing champion, was patient and professional. At the end of the one-hour class, I was sweating all over but felt relaxed.

Despite all these improvements, I have also found something that still needs to be done: so far no basketball court ⁽⁵⁾ _____ (build). I love playing basketball and I hope a basketball court will be built in the near future. I am sure it will make the sports centre more popular.

B3 A school news reporter is interviewing Mr Lin, a PE teacher, about the preparations for the school sports meeting. In pairs, use the checklist below to role-play the interview.

Reporter: Mr Lin, thank you for agreeing to this interview. May I ask what has been prepared for the sports meeting?

Mr Lin: Well, the date of the sports meeting has been decided: 14 May.

...

Reporter: Thank you for your time, Mr Lin. I hope the school sports meeting will be a great success!

Checklist

Date	☒	Rules	☐
Location	☒	Equipment	☐
Events	☐		

Note: A tick "✓" means that the work has been completed.

Integrated skills

Encouraging a friend to work out regularly

A Leo is talking to Dr Chen about some problems with his health. Watch the video and finish the exercises below.



A1 Watch the video and tick the problems Leo mentions in the boxes below.

- ☐ a Always gets a cold
- ☐ b Has a bad memory
- ☐ c Has sleep problems
- ☐ d Is overweight
- ☐ e Cannot concentrate at school
- ☐ f Feels tired at night



A2 Watch the video again and complete the table below.

Dr Chen's suggestions	Benefits
Try a (1) _____ diet.	It will help your body (2) _____.
Be more active. Do some aerobic exercise such as (3) _____ twice a week.	- It will strengthen your immune system so you can (4) _____. - It will (5) _____, making you feel tired and sleep better at night. - It will help (6) _____, which may help you concentrate.

Tip

Listening for suggestions

When making suggestions, speakers often use expressions like *why not try ...*, *it would be good to ...* and *it'll be even better if you can ...*. Pay attention to these expressions and listen for the suggestions that follow.

B After his conversation with Dr Chen, Leo wrote an email to his friend Rachel. Read the email below and make a list of the reasons why Leo is unwilling to begin working out regularly.

Hi Rachel,

Hope you're doing well. I've been feeling a bit under the weather recently: generally tired and not myself. Today I went to see the doctor. She offered me some advice on my diet. She also said I needed to do more exercise.

I know that I'll have a better immune system and higher energy levels if I exercise. To be honest though, I don't know how to make exercise a regular part of my life. You know, it's really difficult to fit exercise into my busy schedule. I have so much schoolwork. Plus I take part in a lot of after-school activities. During the weekend, I often hang out with my friends. I simply have no time for exercise!

It isn't just about the time, though. I'm also concerned about money. I just can't afford to sign up for classes in the nearby gym. I do want to try swimming but the swimming classes are so expensive. So you see, I don't think I'd be able to work out in the gym.

Last but not least, I think it's hard for me to stick with an exercise routine. How boring it is to exercise alone! Imagine jogging along the same path every morning, repeating the same movement day after day and having no one to talk to! I'm pretty sure I would soon give up without a partner.

What would you do in my position? Look forward to hearing from you soon.

Best wishes,
Leo

Reasons why Leo is unwilling to take up exercise:

- 1 _____
- 2 _____
- 3 _____

C In pairs, role-play a conversation between Rachel and Leo about how Leo can make exercise a regular part of his life. Use the following ideas to help you.

- Exercise can be fitted into one's schedule.
- Exercise does not necessarily require money.
- Exercise can be done with one's family or friends.

Tip

Starting a discussion

To start a discussion, you can:

- state the purpose directly, e.g.
I have this idea/problem to discuss with you.
I'd like to discuss something/my problem/my situation with you.
- invite your partner to give his/her opinion by asking questions. Try to ask open-ended questions rather than yes-no questions, e.g.
What do you think of ...?
How do you feel about ...?

D Help Rachel write a reply to Leo to encourage him to work out regularly. Use your ideas from part C and the information in parts A and B to help you.

Planning your writing

• Learning about the structure

When writing an email of encouragement, you can follow the structure below:

- Start by showing your understanding of the situation.
- Give suggestions with reasons.
- End the email by offering encouragement.

• Learning about writing techniques

- Read the instructions carefully to fully understand the topic and brainstorm ideas.
- Use diagrams, such as a mind map or a flow chart, to organize your ideas. You can also make a list of the points you want to cover.

• Learning about the language

- Consider the purpose of your writing and your reader, which determine your language style, formal or informal. An email to encourage a friend is usually informal.
- Show your understanding with expressions such as "I'm sorry to hear that ..." and end your email with "I hope you'll find these suggestions helpful and I'm sure you'll ...".

Checking your writing

Remember to check your writing after you finish and exchange drafts between you and your partner. Pay attention to the following aspects:

- | | | |
|--|--|------------------------------------|
| ☐ Punctuation | ☐ Spelling | ☐ Grammar |
| ☐ Choice of words | ☐ Style (formal/informal) | ☐ Structure |

Self-review

- Are the reasons you give convincing?
Do you use proper language to express understanding and encouragement?
- How can you improve your writing?

Peer review

- What does your partner think of the suggestions and reasons you give?
- How can you improve your writing?

Extended reading



Read the sports magazine article about a Chinese high school student's experience of practising tai chi.



Finding a balance: my tai chi experience

When my friend first suggested that we join the new Tai Chi Club at school, I hesitated. I always believed tai chi was for old people. After the first class, however, I had to admit that I had been wrong about tai chi. It was amazing! One year later, I can honestly say it has had a huge effect on me physically and mentally. Just
5 as importantly, practising tai chi has inspired me to explore the Chinese culture behind it.

The first few tai chi classes were fun and easy, and the moves really caught my imagination, with descriptive names like “white crane spreading its wings” and “golden rooster standing on one leg”. When I asked my coach where these
10 interesting names came from, he told me about the history of tai chi. Zhang Sanfeng, a 13th-century Taoist, was said to have invented tai chi after drawing inspiration from a fight between a snake and a bird. However, nowadays people tend to believe that Chen Wangting, a 17th-century master of Chinese martial arts, developed tai chi based on martial arts skills. No wonder some tai chi moves
15 are named after animals—Chinese martial arts have a long-standing practice of imitating animals. Chen Wangting's original set of moves is called Chen-style tai chi, but other styles of tai chi have since been developed, including Yang-style, Wu-style and Sun-style.

After learning the basics of tai chi in those first few
20 classes, I found myself bored and aching from doing the
same moves over and over again. Luckily, my coach
taught me how to relax my muscles and focus on
peace of mind while performing the routine. With
these requirements of tai chi in mind, I found to my
25 satisfaction that my balance and flexibility slowly
improved, that I was able to do more difficult
moves, and that my love for tai chi returned
stronger than ever.



In time, I began to look into the ancient Chinese culture behind tai chi.
30 I discovered that tai chi is deeply rooted in the Chinese philosophy of yin and yang,
which are believed to form the unity of opposites. Neither can exist independent
of the other; for example, there is no shadow without light. The practice of tai
chi aims to maintain the balance of yin and yang in the body through opposite
movements: forwards and backwards, up and down, left and right, breathing in
35 and breathing out. Eventually, tai chi brings about a state of physical balance and
mental peace.

A year of practising tai chi has had a positive effect on my everyday life. I sleep
better at night, and I am more energetic during the day. I feel happier and more
confident. Tai chi has taught me to relax my mind, enabling me to stay cool in
40 stressful situations. I am sure I will continue to practise tai chi and enjoy the
benefits it has brought me.

A What was the author's tai chi experience like? Write about it in your own words using the information from the article.

B Do you think tai chi will get more popular among teenagers? Why or why not?

Project

Doing a survey on students' exercise habits

A As a class, discuss what to ask on your questionnaire about the exercise habits of the students in your school. Use the ideas below to help you and think of more ideas for your questionnaire.

- How often do you exercise?
- How long do you exercise?
- What type of exercise do you do?
- Where do you exercise?

B As a group, design your questionnaire and use it to survey the exercise habits of the students in your school.

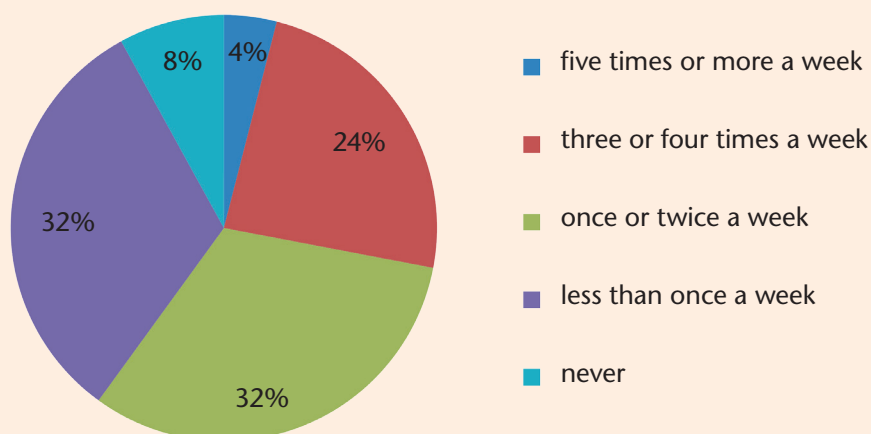
Tip

Designing a questionnaire

Think carefully about what you want to find out from the survey and design your questionnaire accordingly. Moreover, use a mixture of closed-ended questions and open-ended questions. Last but not least, keep your questionnaire short and easy to understand.

C As a group, write a report about the survey data you have gathered and make suggestions on how students can improve their exercise habits. Use the example below, which is part of a report, to help you. Then present your report to the rest of the class.

How often do students exercise?



Most students need to do a lot more exercise if they wish to remain healthy. Experts recommend exercising at least three times a week, but only 28% of students manage that. From the diagram, we can also see that 40% of students exercise less than once a week or never exercise. It can be seen that most students need to exercise more frequently.

UNIT 3

Festivals and customs

Customs tell a man who he is, where he belongs, what he must do.

—Robert A. Heinlein



In this unit, you are going to:

- read a travel journal about a traveller's experiences in two different countries;
- write an article to promote traditional Chinese festivals;
- read a feature article about a family dinner on the Chinese New Year's Eve;
- make PPT slides about a festival.

Welcome to the unit



Festivals can tell us a lot about the cultures of different countries. Watch the video and finish the following exercises.



- Yi Peng Lantern Festival is celebrated in Chiang Mai, Thailand as a way to _____.
- Midsummer's Day is celebrated in Sweden for people to _____.
- The Day of the Dead, which lasts _____, is a festival in Mexico for people to _____.

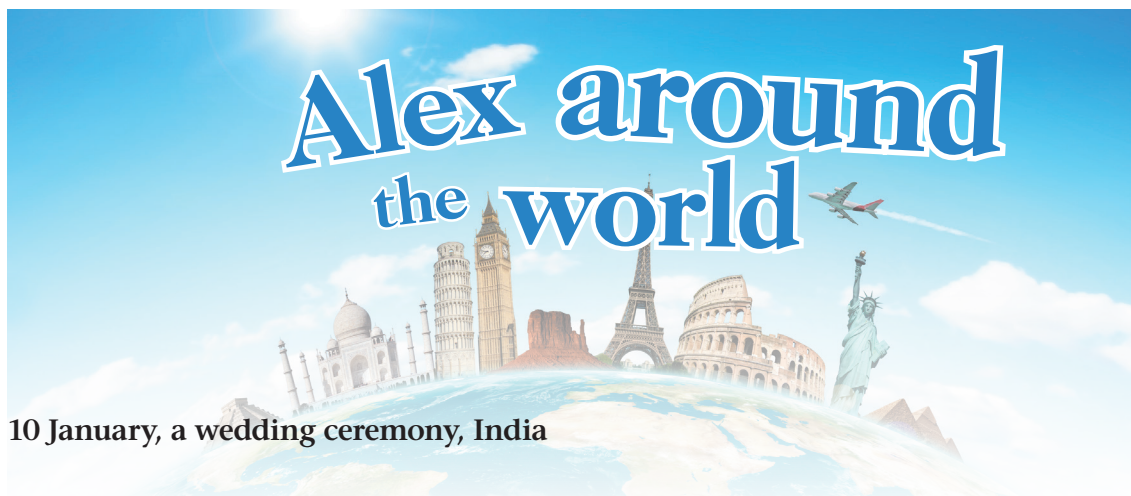
- 1 What Chinese festivals are similar to each of the three festivals in the video?
- 2 What other festivals around the world do you know about?

Reading



Travelling is a way to learn about other cultures. The travel journal below was written by Alex Zhang, a travel writer. He shares his experiences of attending an Indian wedding and the Rio Carnival. Before you read the travel journal, think about the following questions:

- How can you learn about foreign customs and traditions?
- Describe a festival you have experienced. What happened? What was it like?



10 January, a wedding ceremony, India

When Nadim invited me to his sister's wedding, I knew it would be the opportunity of a lifetime. I was definitely not wrong!

The wedding ceremony took place in a brightly decorated hotel room. There were
5 hundreds of guests, all dressed up in formal, colourful clothes. According to tradition, the bride was wearing an eye-catching red silk sari.

I did not understand all of the traditional customs, but a few made a deep impression on me. One was the bridegroom's entrance on a beautiful white horse. I had never seen that back home! Another was the part when Nadim's father proudly led his daughter
10 through the rows of seats to her husband. It reminded me of my sister's wedding. Although our cultures are so different, the smiling faces are the same.



The customs that followed were anything but ordinary. The couple joined hands and walked around a small fire four times. Then they took seven steps together by the fire, and with each step made a different promise about how they were going to support
15 each other and live together happily. It was very romantic!

After the ceremony, it was time for the celebrations. That is a story for another day, but let's just say there was a lot of dancing. Now I know I have two
20 left feet ... and both of them hurt!

26 February, Rio Carnival, Brazil

The summer heat hit me as soon as I got off the flight. No wonder people from Rio take a week off for this happy occasion. I could feel it already—the Carnival was in the air!

To experience the spirit of the Carnival for myself, I went to a street party. Luckily,
25 I arrived just in time—the show was about to begin as I took my place in the merry crowd. I could see a group of around 20 Brazilian dancers and a band in fancy costumes standing in the street. Some of them carried flags, which blew in the wind. The crowd waited with excitement.

Then there was an explosion of bright colours and lively music, and the group jumped
30 into action. The band started playing an energetic samba beat, the dancers twisted and turned, and the crowd began to cheer, clap and sing. The whole group started marching down the street. The Carnival current carried us through the ever-growing sea of people, dancing all the way. Iceboxes of soft drinks and beer lined the narrow streets, and the smell of roasted meat filled the air as we passed wave after wave of street
35 stands. I was so caught up in the party fever that I hardly noticed five hours fly by!

Even as I lay in bed that evening, the bright colours and lively music were still swimming all around me. What an amazing first day in Rio!

